

A NORTHERN CENTURY BRIEFING

The Northern Century.

The North is not the whole future. It is the new fulcrum — where the contests over security, climate and capital now converge. This is the case for convening the people who will decide what happens there.

66°33'N ————— ARCTIC CIRCLE ————— 2026-2050

A new fulcrum point.

Every era has a place where its great questions meet. For this one, that place is *the North* — and almost no one is convening the people who must answer them.

The Northern Century is CityAge's founding argument. Not that the future belongs to the North — the future will be contested everywhere — but that the North has become the fulcrum on which much of it turns: the point where the security of two continents, the stability of the planet's climate system, and the next economy's resource and space ambitions all apply their weight at once.

Consider what now runs through northern latitudes. Continental missile defence — the Golden Dome debate, NORAD's modernization — depends on northern radar, northern territory, northern consent. NATO's centre of gravity has shifted toward the Nordic and Baltic north, while rival powers build icebreakers and northern bases of their own.

At the same time, the Arctic remains a load-bearing wall of the biosphere: the engine room of ocean circulation, the calving ground of the world's ice, and the breeding ground for migratory birds and marine mammals whose ranges touch every continent. What happens to the North happens, eventually, to everyone.

Yet the conversation remains fragmented. Defence talks to defence. Mining talks to mining. Conservation talks to itself. The Arctic file sits in a dozen ministries across eight countries. No platform consistently puts the builders, financiers, commanders, scientists and policymakers of the northern fulcrum in one room, under an editorial standard they trust. That is the gap Northern Century fills.

3%

OF EARTH'S SURFACE WHERE
CONSEQUENTIAL DECISIONS ARE
MADE

100+

CITYAGE CONVENINGS
OVER FIFTEEN YEARS

25,000

VERIFIED DECISION-
MAKERS IN THE
NETWORK

Three forces, one fulcrum.

Each of these forces is reshaping policy and capital on its own. They converge on the same map — and on the same relatively small group of people who must act on it.

1 The security realignment

For the first time since the Cold War, the polar approaches are a first-order security theatre. Washington's proposed Golden Dome missile shield cannot function without northern sensing and northern territory; Canada has committed C\$38.6 billion to NORAD modernization, with Arctic over-the-horizon radar due online in 2029. NATO's enlargement has made the alliance a northern power, even as rivals expand their own icebreaker fleets and polar presence. The competing interests are no longer theoretical — they are funded.

2 The planetary system

The Arctic is not a region; it is infrastructure for the biosphere. Its ice and cold drive the ocean circulation that regulates climate far to the south. Its tundra and coastlines are the breeding grounds for migratory birds from six continents, and its waters sustain the whales, seals and walrus that anchor entire marine food webs. The North is warming faster than anywhere on Earth. Decisions about its development are decisions about planetary systems — which is precisely why they cannot be left to any single industry's room.

3 The resource & space economy

Critical minerals, northern energy, polar-orbit launch and sensing, cold-climate data infrastructure: the technologies of the next economy favour northern geography. The capital is moving first; the policy frameworks and the public narrative are racing to catch up. The gap between the two is where a trusted convener earns its keep.

C\$38.6B

CANADA'S NORAD
MODERNIZATION
COMMITMENT

US\$175B

PROJECTED COST OF
THE PROPOSED
GOLDEN DOME
SHIELD

2029

ARCTIC OVER-THE-
HORIZON RADAR
SCHEDULED ONLINE

4×

RATE AT WHICH THE
ARCTIC WARMS
RELATIVE TO THE
GLOBE

Two capitals, one corridor.

Northern Century is built as a two-node franchise. Each node anchors one side of the North Atlantic security and economic relationship; the franchise travels between them.

FLAGSHIP • NORTH ATLANTIC

Ottawa

The political capital of the Northern Century's largest landmass. Home to the Arctic file, the NORAD relationship, the critical-minerals strategy and the diplomatic corps of the Nordic, Baltic and polar nations. CityAge's 2026 Ottawa convening assembled ambassadors, commanders and northern leaders under one roof — the proof of concept for the flagship.

ANCHOR • DEFENCE & SPACE

Arlington, Virginia

The decision corridor of American defence and the fastest-growing address in the space economy. The Pentagon, the primes, the agencies and the investors who will fund the Northern Century's hardware sit within a few miles of each other. An Arlington convening puts Canadian and Nordic ambition directly in front of American capital and command.

HOME BASE • PACIFIC GATEWAY

Vancouver

CityAge's headquarters and the Pacific door to the North — the port, capital pool and talent base through which Asia meets the northern economy.

Three engines, one franchise.

Northern Century is not an event. It is a franchise with three reinforcing engines, each generating intelligence and relationships for the other two.

ENGINE 01 • CONVENING

The Rooms

Flagship summits in Ottawa and Arlington, with curated micro-networks — eight to twelve principals, assembled around a single partner's objective — as the premium tier. Invitation-only, editorially programmed, no pay-to-play panels.

ENGINE 02 • INTELLIGENCE

Northern Century Signals

A paid intelligence vertical: concise, sourced, written in a correspondent's voice rather than a consultant's. Briefings and quarterly reports for the people who can't be in every room but need to know what was said in them.

ENGINE 03 • ADVISORY

The Studio

CityAge's private advisory practice, applying the Studio System — a methodology for building influence through convening, editorial and campaigns — for a small number of partners aligned with the Northern Century thesis.

The model is deliberate: events build the network, the network feeds the intelligence, the intelligence earns the advisory — *and the byline holds it all together.*

Led from the North, not about it.

Miro Cernetig

FOUNDER & PUBLISHER • CITYAGE

Three decades reporting on the people who run the world, from Gorbachev to Thatcher — including years above the treeline.

Bureau Chief, The Globe and Mail

BEIJING • NEW YORK • THE ARCTIC • VANCOUVER

Michener Award

CANADA'S HIGHEST HONOUR FOR PUBLIC-SERVICE JOURNALISM

Polar Bear Safari

DOCUMENTARY FILMED OVER TWO WEEKS ON THE ICE, BY DOGSLED

"We are not retained by the industries we cover. The room is curated by editors, not underwriters — that is the entire value of the room."

Northern Century's counsel is drawn from people who have governed, commanded and built in the North — not merely written about it. The advisory circle, now in formation:

The Hon. Dennis Patterson

ADVISORY COUNSEL • INFORMATION

Premier of the Northwest Territories, 1987–1991. Senator for Nunavut, 2009–2023. A principal figure in the negotiation of the Nunavut Land Claims Agreement and the creation of Nunavut itself — one of the few people alive who has redrawn the map of the North.

Further appointments

TO BE ANNOUNCED • 2026

Northern premiers, polar commanders, Indigenous leaders, Nordic and Baltic diplomats, and the scientists who know the ice — assembled deliberately, and slowly, because the counsel is the franchise.

The century is finding its
fulcrum.

Be in the room when it tips.

Northern Century partnerships are limited by design: a small number of title and knowledge partners per convening, selected for alignment with the thesis. Partners shape the questions on the table. They do not buy the answers.

Ottawa

NORTH ATLANTIC FLAGSHIP

Arlington

DEFENCE & SPACE ANCHOR • 2027

Signals

PAID INTELLIGENCE VERTICAL

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AN URBAN PLANET FRANCHISE

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